



Sorcerer's Combat Primer

Baldur's Gate 3 combat mechanics, five lessons and
five reference sheets

ALL RULES CITED TO BG3.WIKI

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PART I

The lessons



Five lessons teach the mathematics of BG3 combat. Each lesson teaches one skill. Read one lesson in 10 minutes or less. Each lesson ends with a check and an answer key.

LESSON 1

Where the hit chance comes from

BG3 MECHANICS · LESSON 1 · ABOUT 8 MINUTES

BG3 shows a percentage for each weapon attack and each spell attack. That percentage comes from one d20 roll plus a bonus, compared against a number. This lesson gives you the formula. Then you apply the formula until you can predict the tooltip yourself.

THE ONE FORMULA

```
d20 + ability modifier + proficiency bonus ≥ target's Armour  
Class → hit
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The formula is complete. The wiki states it as "Result = d20 + Ability score modifier + Proficiency bonus". A hit happens when the result equals or exceeds the Armour Class.

Source: bg3.wiki, Attack roll.

Your Sorcerer is level 2 and has 16 Charisma. The ability modifier is +3 and the proficiency bonus is +2. The spell attack bonus is therefore +5. Gale has 17 Intelligence, so his bonus is also +5.

Proficiency by level: bg3.wiki, Sorcerer.

Two faces of the die ignore the formula. A natural 20 always hits and is a critical hit. A natural 1 always misses.

Source: bg3.wiki, Attack roll.

CONVERSION OF THE FORMULA TO A PERCENTAGE

Subtract your bonus from the Armour Class of the target. The result is the lowest die face that hits. Count the faces from that number to 20. Then divide the count by 20.

Example: the bonus is +5 and the enemy has AC 13. You need $13 - 5 = 8$ or higher. Faces 8 to 20 are 13 faces. $13 \div 20 = 65$ percent. The tooltip shows this number.

Use the calculator. Set the AC to 18. The number falls to 40 percent. Then set the bonus to 7. This shows the effect of one more point of Charisma and one more point of proficiency. Each +1 adds exactly one face on the die, which is 5 percentage points. The natural 1 and natural 20 limits stop this pattern.

THE EFFECT OF ADVANTAGE

Advantage means that the game rolls two d20s and keeps the higher die. Disadvantage keeps the lower die. Nothing else changes: the bonus and the AC stay the same.

Source: bg3.wiki, Advantage.

The percentage changes a lot, because only *one* of the two dice must reach the target number. A flat roll that hits 65 percent of the time misses 35 percent of the time. With advantage you miss only when both dice miss: $0.35 \times 0.35 = 12$ percent. Therefore you hit 88 percent of the time. With disadvantage you hit only when both dice hit: $0.65 \times 0.65 = 42$ percent.

Two rules cause frequent errors. Both rules come directly from the wiki:

- Sources never stack. Three reasons for advantage still give two dice. "Creatures receive no additional benefit or penalty from having multiple sources of advantage or disadvantage."
- One of each cancels everything. Two sources of advantage and one source of disadvantage give a flat roll. "Creatures that have both advantage and disadvantage on a roll only roll a single die, even if they have multiple sources of either."

Set the calculator above to Advantage and then to Disadvantage. Compare the results at different ACs. The change is largest in the middle of the range. At 95 percent or 5 percent the change is very small.

A CORRECTION: HIGH GROUND IS NOT ADVANTAGE

Many guides say that high ground gives advantage. I gave you this same wrong information earlier in our conversation. The released game does not work in this way. An attack from at least 2.5 m above the target gives a flat +2 to the attack roll. An attack from below gives -2.

Source: bg3.wiki, High ground rules.

This rule gives you a better result. The bonus is flat and not advantage. Therefore it stacks with real advantage from a prone target or a blinded target. High ground plus a knocked-down enemy gives +2 *and* two dice.

PRACTICE: THE TOOLTIP REBUILD

Do this task in your next fight, before you read more. Hover over an attack and note the percentage. Roll the attack. Then open the combat log with the scroll icon at the bottom right. Find the line for that attack. The line lists the die, each modifier by name, and the AC. Confirm that the percentage matches the formula.

CHECK YOURSELF

- 1 Your attack bonus is +5 and the enemy has AC 15. Flat roll. What is the hit chance?
 - A. 50 percent chance
 - B. 55 percent chance
 - C. 60 percent chance
 - D. 65 percent chance
 - 2 You are hidden (advantage), on high ground (+2), and the target is prone (advantage). How many dice do you roll?
 - A. One die, plus two
 - B. Two dice, plus two
 - C. Three dice, plus two
 - D. Two dice, plus four
 - 3 Same shot, but now you are also threatened by an adjacent enemy (disadvantage on ranged attacks). What happens?
 - A. Two dice, keep lower
 - B. Two dice, keep higher
 - C. One die, flat roll
 - D. Three dice, keep middle
 - 4 Your flat hit chance is 50 percent. With advantage it becomes roughly what?
 - A. About 60 percent
 - B. About 65 percent
 - C. About 75 percent
 - D. About 85 percent
-

PRIMARY SOURCE

Read the [bg3.wiki Advantage page](#). The page is short. It gives the average-roll numbers. It also links to the full list of sources of advantage and disadvantage. Ten minutes on that page cover all the content of this lesson.

ANSWERS

1. **B.** You need $15 - 5 = 10$ or higher. Faces 10 to 20 are 11 faces. $11 \div 20 = 55$ percent.
2. **B.** Advantage never stacks. Two sources still give two dice. High ground is a flat +2 and not advantage, so it adds to the roll.
3. **C.** Any disadvantage cancels any advantage. The result is one flat die. The number of sources does not change this. The +2 from high ground still applies.
4. **C.** You miss only when both dice miss: $0.5 \times 0.5 = 25$ percent. Therefore you hit 75 percent. Advantage is largest in the middle of the range.

LESSON 2

Saving throws and Spell Save DC

BG3 MECHANICS · LESSON 2 · ABOUT 9 MINUTES

Lesson 1 covered the rolls that you make. This lesson covers the rolls that the enemy makes. Most of your spells never roll an attack. Instead the target rolls a saving throw against one fixed number. That number is your Spell Save DC. This lesson teaches you to compute the DC, to read the save of the target, and to choose the spell that the target is least able to resist.

TWO KINDS OF HARMFUL SPELL

BG3 splits harmful spells into two groups. Spells in the form of a ray or a projectile need an attack roll against the Armour Class of the target. All other harmful spells let the target attempt a saving throw.

Source: bg3.wiki, Spellcasting.

Lesson 1 gave you the first group. This lesson gives you the second group. Read the spell tooltip and find the words "Save" or "Saving Throw". Those words tell you which group the spell is in.

THE ONE FORMULA

Spell Save DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + spellcasting ability modifier

target: d20 + ability modifier + proficiency bonus (if proficient) ≥ DC → the target saves

The target succeeds when the result equals or exceeds your Spell Save DC.

Source: bg3.wiki, Saving throw.

Your Sorcerer casts with Charisma and has 16 Charisma, so the ability modifier is +3. At level 2 the proficiency bonus is +2. Therefore your Spell Save DC is $8 + 2 + 3 = 13$. Gale casts with Intelligence and has 17 Intelligence, so his modifier is also +3 and his DC is also 13.

Spellcasting ability by class: bg3.wiki, Spellcasting. Proficiency by level: bg3.wiki, Sorcerer.

At character level 5 the proficiency bonus rises to +3. Your DC then rises to 14 without any change to Charisma.

Source: bg3.wiki, Sorcerer.

One important difference from lesson 1: a saving throw has no automatic result. A natural 20 does not grant an automatic success and a natural 1 does not force an automatic failure. The only exceptions are concentration saves and dialogue saves.

Source: bg3.wiki, Saving throw.

CONVERSION OF THE DC TO A PERCENTAGE

Subtract the save bonus of the target from your Spell Save DC. The result is the lowest die face on which the target succeeds. Count the faces from that number to 20. Then divide the count by 20. That fraction is the chance of a save. The rest of the die is your chance to land the spell.

Example: your DC is 13 and the target has a Wisdom save bonus of -1. The target needs $13 - (-1) = 14$ or higher. Faces 14 to 20 are 7 faces. $7 \div 20 = 35$ percent for the save. Therefore the spell lands 65 percent of the time.

Use the calculator. Set the save bonus to +3, which is a common value for a strong save. The chance to land falls to 45 percent. Then set the DC to 14 for level 5. The chance rises to 50 percent. Each point of difference between the DC and the save bonus is one face on the die, which is 5 percentage points.

ADVANTAGE AND DISADVANTAGE ON SAVES

Advantage and disadvantage apply to saving throws in the same way as to attack rolls. The wiki states that "Rolling two dice only applies to d20 rolls: Attack Rolls, Saving Throws, and Ability Checks." The same two rules from lesson 1 apply. Multiple sources do not stack, and one source of each cancels to a single flat die.

Source: bg3.wiki, Advantage.

Disadvantage on a save is strong, because the target must clear the DC on both dice. Return to the example. A flat save of 35 percent becomes $0.35 \times 0.35 = 12.25$ percent with disadvantage. Your chance to land the spell rises from 65 percent to 87.8 percent. Set the calculator to "Target has disadvantage" and confirm this result.

Your class buys this effect directly. The Heightened Spell Metamagic costs 3 sorcery points and gives the target disadvantage on its first saving throw. Your Sorcerer gains access

to this option at class level 3.

Source: bg3.wiki, Sorcerer.

THE EXAMINE PANEL

Do not guess the save of a target. Read it. Hover over the creature and press T. The wiki states that "A target's saving throws can be checked by examining them (shortcut 'T')." The panel also lists resistances and current conditions.

Source: bg3.wiki, Abilities. Source: Prima Games, How to examine enemy weaknesses and resistances.

The panel gives the ability score and the save number together. Convert a score to a modifier in this way: subtract 10 from the score, divide by 2, and round down. A score of 8 gives -1. A score of 12 gives +1. A score of 19 gives +4.

Source: bg3.wiki, Abilities.

Warning: the save number can exceed the ability modifier, because a proficient creature adds its proficiency bonus. Read the save number itself when the panel shows it, and use the ability modifier only as a fallback.

Source: bg3.wiki, Saving throw.

CHOICE OF THE WEAKEST SAVE

A low ability score gives a low save. Therefore the correct question before a cast is short: which of my spells targets the lowest number on this panel?

Two patterns help you to make a first guess. Large brutes usually have low Dexterity and low Wisdom. Nimble enemies usually have low Strength and low Wisdom. Treat both patterns as a guess and confirm the guess in the Examine panel. The following three stat blocks show the pattern on real enemies.

CREATURE	STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
Goblin Warrior	+1	+1	+0	+0	-1	-1
Ogre Brute	+4	+1	+3	-3	-2	-2
Ochre Jelly	+2	-2	+2	-4	-2	-5

Ability modifiers on Balanced difficulty. Sources: bg3.wiki, Goblin Warrior, bg3.wiki, Ogre Brute, bg3.wiki, Ochre Jelly. Other difficulties change some scores.

Read the three rows against your DC 13. Wisdom is the lowest save or an equal-lowest save in all three rows. A Wisdom spell against the Ogre Brute needs a 15 from the target, which is 6 faces, so the spell lands 70 percent of the time. A Constitution spell against the

same target needs a 10, which is 11 faces, so that spell lands only 45 percent of the time. The same DC gives a difference of 25 percentage points.

Enemy player-class characters follow the class table instead. A Fighter is proficient in Strength and Constitution saves. A Rogue is proficient in Dexterity and Intelligence saves. Target the two abilities that the class table does not list.

Full table: [bg3.wiki](#), Saving throw, and the reference sheet.

YOUR LOW-LEVEL SAVE SPELLS

SPELL	LEVEL	SAVE	EFFECT OF A SUCCESSFUL SAVE
Grease	1	Dexterity	The creature does not fall Prone. Wizard list, or a Black or Acid Draconic Sorcerer.
Burning Hands	1	Dexterity	The target still takes half damage.
Thunderwave	1	Constitution	The target takes half damage and is not pushed.
Ray of Sickness	1	Constitution, after an attack roll	The target avoids Poisoned but still takes the damage.
Tasha's Hideous Laughter	1	Wisdom	The target avoids the condition. Gale only, not the Sorcerer.
Hold Person	2	Wisdom	The target avoids the condition and repeats the save each turn. Humanoid targets only.
Sleep	1	None	No save. The spell affects creatures with cumulative HP below 24.

Three points matter here. Sleep ignores this whole lesson, because it uses a hit point threshold and not a saving throw. Ray of Sickness needs both rolls: your attack roll against the Armour Class, and then a Constitution save against the Poisoned condition. Tasha's Hideous Laughter is on the Wizard list and not on the Sorcerer list, so it belongs to Gale.

Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Sleep. Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Ray of Sickness. Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Tasha's Hideous Laughter.

Note the second column of effects. A damage spell such as Burning Hands still deals half damage on a save. A condition spell such as Hold Person gives you nothing on a save. Therefore save the sorcery points for the condition spells, where a failure costs you the whole action.

PRACTICE: THE PREDICTION BEFORE THE CAST

Do this task in your next fight. Choose one enemy and press T. Write down the six save numbers. Compute the chance for two spells with the formula: your DC minus the save bonus gives the needed face, and the faces below that number are your chance to land the spell. Cast the better spell. Then open the combat log and confirm the die roll, the modifier, and the DC against your numbers.

CHECK YOURSELF

- 1 Your Sorcerer reaches level 5 and takes an Ability Improvement to Charisma 18. What is the Spell Save DC?

A. The DC is 13	B. The DC is 14
C. The DC is 15	D. The DC is 16
 - 2 Your DC is 13. The target has a Wisdom save of -1. You cast a Wisdom spell. How often does the spell land?

A. 35 percent to land	B. 50 percent to land
C. 65 percent to land	D. 80 percent to land
 - 3 The Examine panel shows Str +4, Dex +1, Con +3, Int -3, Wis -2, Cha -2. Which spell gives the best chance?

A. The Wisdom save spell	B. The Dexterity save spell
C. The Strength save spell	D. The Constitution save spell
 - 4 The target rolls a natural 20 on a saving throw against your spell. What happens?

A. Nothing special. The modifier still applies.	B. The save always succeeds against spells.
C. The save succeeds and reflects damage.	D. The target gains advantage next turn.
-

PRIMARY SOURCE

Read the [bg3.wiki Saving throw page](#). The page is short. It gives the Spell Save DC formula, the natural 1 and natural 20 exception, and the full class proficiency table. Ten minutes on that page cover all the rules of this lesson.

ANSWERS

1. **C.** Charisma 18 gives +4. Level 5 gives a proficiency bonus of +3. $8 + 3 + 4 = 15$.
2. **C.** The target needs $13 - (-1) = 14$ or higher. Faces 14 to 20 are 7 faces, so the save is 35 percent. The spell lands 65 percent of the time.
3. **A.** Wisdom is -2 and is the lowest save with Charisma. Few low-level spells target Charisma, so the Wisdom spell is the best choice.
4. **A.** Saving throws have no automatic success on a natural 20 and no automatic failure on a natural 1. Concentration saves and dialogue saves are the only exceptions.

LESSON 3

Damage types and resistances

BG3 MECHANICS · LESSON 3 · ABOUT 10 MINUTES

A hit that lands can still deal half damage, or no damage at all. The target decides this, not your roll. This lesson teaches you to read the resistances of the target before you cast, to pick a damage type that the target does not resist, and to create a vulnerability on purpose with water.

THE 13 DAMAGE TYPES

Baldur's Gate 3 has 13 damage types in three groups.

Source: bg3.wiki, Damage types.

GROUP	TYPES
Physical	Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing
Elemental	Acid, Cold, Fire, Lightning, Poison, Thunder
Other	Force, Necrotic, Psychic, Radiant

Every damage instance in the game carries exactly one of these labels. The label decides which of the three modifiers below applies.

THE THREE MODIFIERS

resistance → $\text{damage} \div 2$, rounded down
vulnerability → $\text{damage} \times 2$
immunity → $\text{damage} = 0$

The wiki gives the resistance rule in one sentence: "*Resistance* means the total damage taken from a type of damage is *halved* (rounded down)."

Source: bg3.wiki, Resistances.

Three rules control how the modifiers combine. Learn all three.

- Multiple resistances to the same damage type do not stack. Two sources give the same half damage as one source.
- Resistance and vulnerability to the same damage type cancel each other. The target then takes normal damage.
- Immunity ignores both of the other modifiers. "*Immunity* means the total damage taken from a type of damage is *reduced to 0*. This means the creature takes no damage of that type, even if another effect applies vulnerability to the same type."

Sources: [bg3.wiki](#), Damage types and [bg3.wiki](#), Resistances.

Set the base damage to 9 and step through the five target states. Note two results. Immunity turns a good roll into nothing. "Resistant and vulnerable" returns the full 9, because the two modifiers cancel. Note also that the calculator rounds down. Resistance against 9 damage gives 4, not 4.5.

HOW TO READ THE EXAMINE PANEL

Hover the cursor over an enemy and press T. This opens the Examine panel.

Default keybinding "Examine / Pin Tooltip": [bg3.wiki](#), Options.

The panel shows one icon for each damage type. An arrow on an icon marks a modifier. The colour of the arrow tells you which damage sources the modifier covers. The wiki states it directly:

"resistance is indicated by an upwards blue and / or grey arrow on the corresponding element. Grey indicates that non-magical sources of damage are reduced, and blue indicates that magical sources of damage are reduced."

Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Resistances.

Vulnerability uses a downward red arrow. Immunity uses a yellow outline around the shield of the damage type. A grey outline marks immunity to non-magical sources only.

Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Resistances.

The magical and non-magical split matters for you. Spells are magical sources of damage, and so are weapons of uncommon rarity and above. Your Sorcerer therefore reads the blue arrows. A grey arrow alone does not reduce your spell damage. It does reduce the damage from a common weapon in the hands of a melee companion.

Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Resistances.

THREE VERIFIED ACT 1 EXAMPLES

Do not guess the resistances of an enemy. Check the Examine panel, or check the creature page on the wiki. These three creature pages are verified.

CREATURE	MODIFIERS	WHAT TO CAST
Skeleton	Vulnerable to Bludgeoning. Immune to Poison.	Any type except Poison. Bludgeoning is best.
Phase Spider	Resistant to Poison.	Any type except Poison.
Wood Woad	Resistant to Piercing and Bludgeoning. Vulnerable to Fire.	Fire.

The Skeleton page states the reason: "Being composed purely of brittle bone, all skeletons are vulnerable to Bludgeoning damage and immune to Poison damage."

Source: bg3.wiki, Skeleton.

YOUR FLEXIBLE SPELL: CHROMATIC ORB

Chromatic Orb is a level 1 Evocation spell. The Sorcerer and the Wizard learn it at level 1. You choose the element when you cast it. The game lists a separate variant for each element: Acid, Cold, Fire, Lightning, Poison and Thunder.

Source: bg3.wiki, Chromatic Orb.

The damage is not equal across the variants. Thunder deals 3d8. Acid, Cold, Fire, Lightning and Poison each deal 2d8 and create a surface. The Lightning variant creates an Electrified Water surface. The Cold variant creates an Ice surface.

Source: bg3.wiki, Chromatic Orb. Source: bg3.wiki, Chromatic Orb: Lightning. Source: bg3.wiki, Chromatic Orb: Cold.

A note before you plan around it: many summaries give Chromatic Orb as 3d8 for every element. That is wrong. Only the Thunder variant deals 3d8. The five other variants deal 2d8 and add a surface. Treat the extra d8 on Thunder as the price of the surface.

Chromatic Orb needs an attack roll, so a resistance and a miss can both take the damage away. Magic Missile removes one of those two risks. It deals Force damage, it fires three darts of 1d4 + 1, and the darts always hit. Check the Force icon in the Examine panel. If that icon has no arrow, Magic Missile is your answer to an enemy that resists every element.

Source: bg3.wiki, Magic Missile.

THE WET COMBINATION

You can create a vulnerability. The Wet condition changes the target as follows.

Source: bg3.wiki, Wet.

- The target becomes vulnerable to Lightning damage and Cold damage. Both types then deal double damage.
- The target becomes resistant to Fire damage. Fire then deals half damage.
- The target becomes immune to Burning and to Wild Magic: Burning.

Three more rules from the same page control the edge cases:

- A Wet creature that already resists Lightning or Cold loses that resistance. It does not become vulnerable. "Wet entities who are resistant to Lightning or Cold damage have their resistances negated instead of becoming vulnerable."
- A Chilled creature that becomes Wet turns into a Frozen creature. "If a already chilled creature is made wet, both conditions are replaced with Frozen."
- Wet ends normal invisibility at once. "Becoming wet breaks normal invisibility immediately." Do not make your hidden Rogue Wet.

Warning: Wet also makes your own party vulnerable to Lightning and Cold. Place the water on the enemy, and keep your melee characters out of it.

How to apply Wet

Deep water and steam clouds apply Wet. The spell Create Water applies Wet.

Source: bg3.wiki, Wet.

Create or Destroy Water is a level 1 Transmutation spell with a 4 m radius. The Cleric and the Druid learn it at level 1. A Conjuration School Wizard gets the Create Water variant at level 2, once per Short Rest and with no spell slot. A Storm Sorcery Sorcerer gets it at level 6.

Source: bg3.wiki, Create or Destroy Water.

Read that list against your party. Your Sorcerer at level 2 does not have this spell. Gale is an Evocation Wizard, not a Conjuration Wizard, so Gale does not have it either. A Cleric companion or a Druid companion is your source of water. Send the water first, then cast the Lightning orb.

The surface chain

Water on the ground is also a surface, and surfaces react to elements.

Source: bg3.wiki, Surfaces.

SURFACE	DAMAGE APPLIED	RESULT
Water	Lightning	Electrified Water surface
Water	Cold	Ice surface
Water	Fire	Steam Cloud
Ice	—	Prone and Difficult Terrain
Oil	Fire	Explosion, then a Fire surface
Alcohol	Fire	Fire surface

The Steam Cloud is useful. It applies Wet, so a fire spell into water still sets up your next Lightning spell.

Source: bg3.wiki, Wet.

THE MATH, ONE TABLE

Chromatic Orb: Lightning deals 2d8. The average of 2d8 is 9.

Chromatic Orb: Thunder deals 3d8, and the average of 3d8 is 13.5.

Compare the outcomes.

CAST	TARGET STATE	AVERAGE BEFORE	AVERAGE AFTER
Chromatic Orb: Lightning, 2d8	Normal	9	9
Chromatic Orb: Lightning, 2d8	Wet, so vulnerable	9	18
Chromatic Orb: Fire, 2d8	Resistant to Fire	9	4.25
Chromatic Orb: Thunder, 3d8	Normal	13.5	13.5
Magic Missile, $3 \times (1d4 + 1)$	Normal	10.5	10.5

One choice of element moves the result from 4.25 to 18. That is a factor of 4. No other decision on your turn at level 2 changes the damage by that much.

Why 4.25 and not 4.5? Resistance rounds down after each halving. Over all 64 results of 2d8, the rounding removes 0.25 damage on average. Halve first, then round down. Do not round the average.

PRACTICE: ONE EXAMINE, ONE ELEMENT

Do this in your next fight. Complete all four steps before you cast.

- Hover the first enemy and press T to open the Examine panel.

-
- Read the damage type icons. Write down every blue arrow, every red arrow and every yellow outline.
 - Choose a Chromatic Orb element that has no arrow on it. If every element has an arrow, cast Magic Missile for Force damage.
 - If a Cleric or a Druid is in your party, cast Create Water on the enemy first, then cast Chromatic Orb: Lightning. Read the damage number in the combat log and confirm that it is double.
-

CHECK YOURSELF

- 1 The Examine panel shows a blue upward arrow on the Fire icon. You cast a fire spell at that enemy. What happens to the damage?
A. The damage is doubled B. The damage is halved
C. The damage is unchanged D. The damage is removed
 - 2 Your Cleric casts Create Water on an enemy. You then hit that enemy with Chromatic Orb: Lightning for 9 damage. How much damage does the enemy take?
A. 4 damage total B. 9 damage total
C. 18 damage total D. 27 damage total
 - 3 A creature is already resistant to Lightning damage. You make that creature Wet. What is the result for lightning?
A. The creature becomes vulnerable to lightning B. The creature loses its lightning resistance
C. The creature becomes immune to lightning D. The creature keeps its lightning resistance
 - 4 A skeleton is immune to Poison damage. An effect also makes the skeleton vulnerable to Poison damage. What does poison damage do now?
A. Zero poison damage B. Half poison damage
C. Full poison damage D. Double poison damage
-

PRIMARY SOURCE

Read the [bg3.wiki Resistances](#) page. It is short. It shows the exact icons of the Examine panel next to each rule, so you can match the page against your screen. Read the [Wet](#) page after it. Together the two pages take about ten minutes.

ANSWERS

1. **B.** A blue upward arrow marks resistance to magical sources of damage. A spell is a magical source, so resistance halves the damage and rounds down.
2. **C.** Wet gives vulnerability to Lightning damage. Vulnerability doubles the damage, so 9 becomes 18.
3. **B.** Wet negates an existing Lightning or Cold resistance instead of adding vulnerability. The creature then takes normal lightning damage.
4. **A.** Immunity reduces the damage to 0, even when another effect applies vulnerability to the same type. Vulnerability and resistance do not affect immunity.

LESSON 4

Action economy and concentration

BG3 MECHANICS · LESSON 4 · ABOUT 9 MINUTES

Each turn gives you four resources. Most players spend one of them and end the turn. This lesson shows you how to spend all four every turn. It also shows you how to keep one concentration spell active for a complete fight.

THE FOUR RESOURCES OF A TURN

Every creature in the game holds the same set of resources. All of them recharge at the start of the turn of the creature.

Source: bg3.wiki, Resources.

RESOURCE	AMOUNT PER TURN	RECHARGE
Action		1 Start of the turn
Bonus Action		1 Start of the turn
Reaction		1 Start of the turn
Movement Speed	7.5 m to 10.5 m	Start of the turn

The wiki states the rule directly: "All creatures have 1 charge of each of the three resources that recharges at the beginning of each turn, but additional charges can be gained from various sources."

Source: bg3.wiki, Actions.

An unspent resource is a loss. The resource does not carry over to the next turn. Therefore a turn with an unused bonus action is a turn at 75 percent power.

THE ACTION LIST AND THE BONUS ACTION LIST

Every creature has a set of common actions and a set of common bonus actions. Learn which list holds which ability. This knowledge decides how much you fit into one turn.

Source: bg3.wiki, Actions.

COMMON ACTIONS	COMMON BONUS ACTIONS
Dash	Jump
Disengage	Shove
Help	Dip
Main Hand Attack	Off-Hand Attack (Melee)
Ranged Attack	Off-Hand Attack (Ranged)
Throw	
Unarmed Strike	
Improvised Melee Weapon	
Perform	

BG3 differs from tabletop 5e here. In tabletop rules Shove costs an action and a jump is part of movement. In BG3 both Shove and Jump cost a bonus action. This difference is a gift. Your Sorcerer can cast a spell with the action and still push an enemy off a ledge with the bonus action.

Source: bg3.wiki, Actions.

MOVEMENT: THE RESOURCE THAT PLAYERS FORGET

Movement is a resource with a number, not a free extra. Your base speed depends on your race.

Source: bg3.wiki, Movement speed.

- Dwarves, halflings and gnomes move 7.5 m (25 ft) per turn.
- Most other playable races move 9 m (30 ft) per turn.
- Wood elves and wood half-elves move 10.5 m (35 ft) per turn.

Three rules change that number during a fight:

- The Dash action doubles your movement speed for that turn.
Source: bg3.wiki, Movement speed.
- Difficult Terrain halves your movement speed. The wiki states: "requiring 2 m (7 ft) of movement to move 1 m (3 ft) through this type of area." Source: bg3.wiki, Difficult Terrain.
- A creature with the Prone condition must spend half its movement speed to stand up. Source: bg3.wiki, Prone (Condition).

Warning: a knockdown costs you more than one turn of position. The Prone condition ends the turn immediately. On the next turn you also pay half of your movement speed to stand up.

Source: bg3.wiki, Prone (Condition).

THE REACTION: YOUR RESOURCE ON THE ENEMY TURN

You hold 1 reaction per turn. It recharges at the start of your turn. You spend it in response to a trigger, and the trigger often happens on the turn of another creature.

Source: bg3.wiki, Reaction.

Two reactions matter at level 2:

- **Opportunity Attack.** The game describes it as "Automatically attack an enemy moving out of your reach." The Disengage action prevents it. Source: bg3.wiki, Opportunity Attack.
- **Shield.** This level 1 spell costs a reaction and a level 1 spell slot. It raises your Armour Class by 5 and gives immunity to Magic Missile. The effects last until the start of your next turn. Source: bg3.wiki, Shield.

Set your reactions before the fight, not during it. The Reactions tab sits on the spellbook page of the character sheet, and the default hotkey is L. Each reaction has a checkbox for enabled or disabled, plus an "Ask" setting. The "Ask" setting prompts you for confirmation each time the reaction triggers.

Source: bg3.wiki, Reactions.

Some class features use the reaction system but do not spend the Reaction resource. Sneak Attack, Divine Smite and Reckless Attack are examples. A prompt for one of those features does not cost you the Shield reaction later in the round.

Source: bg3.wiki, Reactions.

THE TURN CHECKLIST

Use this checklist for one complete fight. Tick each resource as you spend it, then reset it for the next turn. The target is 4 of 4 on every turn.

CONCENTRATION: ONE SPELL AND ONE SAVING THROW

You can hold only one concentration spell at a time. A second concentration spell ends the first one.

Source: bg3.wiki, Concentration.

Damage puts the spell at risk. On damage you roll a Constitution saving throw.

Concentration DC = half the damage taken, or 10, whichever is higher

A natural 1 on this saving throw almost always ends the concentration. The bonus does not save you on that face.

Source: bg3.wiki, Concentration.

Your Sorcerer has an advantage over Gale here. The Sorcerer is proficient in Constitution saving throws and in Charisma saving throws. The Wizard is proficient in Intelligence and Wisdom, and not in Constitution. Therefore your Sorcerer adds the proficiency bonus to every concentration saving throw, and Gale does not.

Source: bg3.wiki, Saving throw.

Example: your Sorcerer has Constitution 14, so the modifier is +2. The proficiency bonus at level 2 is +2. The concentration save bonus is +4. A goblin arrow deals 7 damage. Half of 7 is 3, so the DC is 10. You need $10 - 4 = 6$ or higher. Faces 6 to 20 are 15 faces, so the chance is 75 percent. A hit for 24 damage gives DC 12. You need 8 or higher, which is 13 faces, so the chance is 65 percent.

Set the Constitution modifier to 0 and turn the proficiency off. This result is the Wizard case. Compare it with the Sorcerer case at the same damage. The gap is the reason to give the concentration spell to your Sorcerer and the damage spell to Gale.

What ends concentration without a saving throw

Damage gives you a saving throw. The following events give you nothing. Each one ends the spell immediately.

Source: bg3.wiki, Concentration.

- You cast a second concentration spell.
- You receive the Downed, Banished, Sleeping, Incapacitated, Prone or Rage condition.
- You dismiss the companion who holds the spell.
- You press the Flee Combat button.
- You cancel the spell with the x on the spell icon.

The Prone entry is the trap. A shove, a grease surface or a knockdown attack ends your Hold Person with no roll. Stay off flammable and slippery ground while you concentrate.

Source: bg3.wiki, Grease.

Which of your spells need concentration

SPELL	LEVEL	CONCENTRATION
Witch Bolt	1	Yes
Hex	1	Yes
Bless	1	Yes
Hold Person	2	Yes
Web	2	Yes
Cloud of Daggers	2	Yes
Haste	3	Yes
Grease	1	No
Ray of Frost	Cantrip	No

Your Sorcerer learns Witch Bolt at class level 1. Your Sorcerer learns Web, Hold Person and Cloud of Daggers at class level 3. Grease is your control option with no concentration cost. Use Grease when you already hold another spell.

Sources: bg3.wiki, Witch Bolt, Web, Hold Person, Cloud of Daggers.

QUICKENED SPELL: A SECOND SPELL IN ONE TURN

Quickened Spell is a Metamagic option. It costs 3 sorcery points. The wiki states the effect as "Spells that take an Action take a Bonus Action instead." It becomes available at Sorcerer level 3.

Source: bg3.wiki, Metamagic.

This option turns your bonus action into a second spell. One example: cast Hold Person with the action, then cast a Quickened Scorching Ray with the bonus action.

A limit exists in tabletop 5e: after a spell with a bonus action, the action can only cast a cantrip. The bg3.wiki Metamagic page states no such limit for BG3. The page gives the cost and the effect and nothing more. Treat this point as unverified until you test it in the game. Report the result to me.

PRACTICE: 4 OF 4 FOR ONE FIGHT

Do this task in your next fight. Open the Reactions tab (hotkey L) before combat starts. Set Shield to "Ask" on your Sorcerer. Then cast one concentration spell on turn 1 and keep it to the end of the fight. On every turn, spend the action, the bonus action and the movement, and end the turn with the reaction still available. Use the checklist above. Count the turns where you reached 4 of 4.

CHECK YOURSELF

- 1 You cast a spell with your action. Which resource does a Shove cost in BG3?
 - A. One bonus action
 - B. One full action
 - C. One free reaction
 - D. One movement point
 - 2 An enemy stands next to you. You want to move away without an opportunity attack against you. What do you use?
 - A. The Disengage action
 - B. The Dash action
 - C. The Help action
 - D. The Throw action
 - 3 Your Sorcerer holds Witch Bolt and takes 24 damage. The concentration save bonus is +4. What is the chance to hold the spell?
 - A. 55 percent
 - B. 65 percent
 - C. 75 percent
 - D. 85 percent
 - 4 Which event ends your concentration immediately, with no saving throw against a DC?
 - A. One hit from an enemy arrow
 - B. One fall to the Prone condition
 - C. One move away from an enemy
 - D. One failed Dexterity saving throw roll
-

PRIMARY SOURCE

Read the [bg3.wiki Concentration page](#). It is short. It gives the DC formula, the complete list of events that end concentration, and the natural 1 rule. Then open the [Reactions page](#) for the list of every reaction in the game.

ANSWERS

1. A. BG3 lists Shove and Jump as common bonus actions. Tabletop 5e uses an action for a shove.
2. A. The wiki states that the Disengage action allows creatures to avoid provoking opportunity attacks. Dash only doubles movement.
3. B. Half of 24 is 12, and 12 is higher than 10, so the DC is 12. You need 8 or higher, which is 13 of 20 faces.
4. B. The wiki states that the Prone condition ends concentration. Damage only forces a Constitution saving throw against the DC.

LESSON 5

Conditions that win fights

BG3 MECHANICS · LESSON 5 · ABOUT 10 MINUTES

A control spell does little damage. A control spell still ends a fight faster than a damage spell. It removes the turn of the enemy, and it changes the attack rolls of your party. This lesson shows you which condition to apply, what each condition does, and how to combine a condition with the attacks of your allies.

WHY A CONDITION BEATS DAMAGE

A damage spell removes hit points. A condition removes the whole turn of the enemy. Prone, Paralysed, Stunned, and Sleeping all stop the creature from taking actions, bonus actions, and reactions.

Sources: bg3.wiki, Prone, Paralysed, Stunned, Sleeping.

The condition also pays a second time. Most of these conditions give advantage on attack rolls against the target. Lesson 1 gives the number: a flat 65 percent becomes 88 percent with advantage.

See Lesson 1 and the d20 cheat sheet.

Two conditions pay a third time. They turn a close hit into an automatic critical hit. This lesson names them below.

One control spell that lands on one enemy for 3 turns removes 3 enemy turns and raises the hit chance of every ally attack for those 3 turns. No level 1 or level 2 damage spell gives that much value.

THE CONDITIONS, AND WHAT EACH ONE DOES

Use the lookup below. Select a condition and read the four rows: what the creature cannot do, what attackers get, which saving throws it fails, and how the condition ends.

Three groups are worth memorising.

- Automatic critical hit group. Paralysed and Sleeping. An attack against a Paralysed creature from within 3 m is always a critical hit. An attack against a Sleeping creature from within 1.5 m is a critical hit. Sources: bg3.wiki, Paralysed, Sleeping.

-
- **Advantage group.** Prone, Restrained, Enwebbed, Stunned, and Blinded. Attack rolls against the target have advantage. Prone gives that advantage only from within 3 m. Sources: [bg3.wiki](#), Restrained, Enwebbed, Blinded.
 - **Weaken group.** Frightened and Threatened. These conditions give no advantage to your attacks. They only reduce the attack rolls of the enemy. Sources: [bg3.wiki](#), Frightened, Threatened.

PRONE: THE CHEAPEST CONTROL

A Prone creature cannot move or take actions, bonus actions, or reactions. It has disadvantage on Strength and Dexterity saving throws. Attacks against it have advantage from within 3 m. It must spend half its movement speed to stand up.

Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Prone.

Warning: the 3 m limit is real. A ranged attack from far away against a Prone target gets no advantage. Send the melee ally, not the archer.

Prone usually lasts 2 turns. Grease, ice, and Throw give 1 turn. If a creature falls Prone on its own turn, the turn ends at once and the concentration of that creature breaks.

Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Prone.

The concentration rule makes Grease a good answer to an enemy caster. The enemy walks into the grease, fails the Dexterity saving throw, falls Prone, loses the turn, and loses the spell it holds.

BLINDED AND THREATENED: TWO DIFFERENT PENALTIES

A Blinded creature has disadvantage on attack rolls. The range of its attacks and spells drops to 3 m. Attack rolls against it have advantage. It cannot make opportunity attacks.

Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Blinded.

Threatened is the condition on *you*, not on the enemy. A hostile creature in melee range gives you disadvantage on ranged attack rolls. A separate source gives disadvantage on a ranged attack against a target within 3 m. Neither source affects a melee attack or a spell that uses a saving throw.

Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Threatened.

This is the reason your Sorcerer casts a saving throw spell when an enemy stands next to you. Ray of Frost needs an attack roll and suffers the disadvantage. A Dexterity saving throw spell does not.

THE LEVEL 1 TO 3 CONTROL LIST

SPELL	LEVEL	CONDITION	SAVING THROW
Sleep	1	Sleeping	None. It affects targets up to a combined 24 hit points.
Grease	1	Prone, for 1 turn	Dexterity
Tasha's Hideous Laughter	1	Prone, plus Hideous Laughter for 10 turns	Wisdom
Hold Person	2	Hold Person, on a humanoid only	Wisdom
Web	2	Enwebbed	Dexterity
Blindness	2	Blinded, for 10 turns	Constitution
Shove	Bonus action	A push of 1 m to 6 m	Athletics against passive Athletics or Acrobatics, whichever is higher

Two notes on this table. Sleep needs no saving throw, so it is the only control spell that a high Wisdom enemy cannot resist. Blindness needs no concentration, so your Sorcerer can hold a second spell at the same time.

Sources: bg3.wiki, Sleep, Blindness.

Warning: Shove does not knock a creature Prone by itself in BG3. Shove pushes the target. A creature that falls at least 8 m from the push is knocked Prone with no saving throw.

Source: bg3.wiki, Shove.

Shove is a bonus action. Your Sorcerer can therefore cast a spell and Shove in the same turn. Use Shove to push an enemy off a ledge, or to move a melee enemy away from Gale.

THE WORKED EXAMPLE: HOLD PERSON PLUS A MELEE ALLY

Your enemy is a humanoid cultist. Your Sorcerer has a Spell Save DC of 13. Follow this order.

- Cast Hold Person on the cultist. The cultist rolls a Wisdom saving throw against DC 13. Source: bg3.wiki, Hold Person.
- On a failure the cultist cannot move or act. Attacks against it succeed automatically. An attack from within 3 m is always a critical hit. Source: bg3.wiki, Hold Person.
- Move Lae'zel into melee range and attack twice. Both attacks are critical hits. Both attacks roll double damage dice.
- Keep the concentration on Hold Person. The cultist rolls a new Wisdom saving throw at the end of each of its turns.

Compare this result with a Magic Missile on the same turn. Magic Missile does about 10 damage and changes nothing else. Hold Person removes every turn of the cultist and doubles the damage dice of every melee attack against it.

A correction: many guides say that Hold Person applies the Paralysed condition. In BG3 the spell applies its own Hold Person condition. The effects are almost the same. The one difference is important: attacks against a Hold Person target succeed automatically, and attacks against a Paralysed target have advantage.

Sources: [bg3.wiki](#), Hold Person, Paralysed.

HOW TO CHOOSE THE SPELL

Choose by the saving throw of the target, not by the damage of the spell. Use this short rule set.

- Against a heavy armoured melee enemy, use Grease or Web. Both use a Dexterity saving throw, and heavy armour usually means low Dexterity.
- Against a low intelligence brute, use Tasha's Hideous Laughter or Hold Person. Both use a Wisdom saving throw.
- Against an archer or a caster with a good Wisdom, use Blindness. It uses a Constitution saving throw, and the range drop to 3 m removes the whole ranged attack of the target.
- Against a group of weak enemies at the start of a fight, use Sleep. It needs no saving throw.

PRACTICE: ONE CONDITION, THEN ONE MELEE ATTACK

Do this in your next fight. Pick the enemy with the most dangerous attack. Apply one condition from the advantage group or the automatic critical hit group. Then move a melee ally to within 3 m and attack. Open the combat log and confirm two lines: the saving throw that the enemy failed, and the advantage or the critical hit on the attack of your ally. Report the two numbers to me.

CHECK YOURSELF

- 1 Your enemy is Prone. Your archer is 12 m away. Does the archer get advantage on the attack roll?

A. Yes, at any attack range	B. No, only within 3 m
C. Yes, but with elevation only	D. No, Prone removes all advantage

- 2 Which condition turns a melee hit from within 3 m into an automatic critical hit?

A. Blinded, from a Blindness spell	B. Restrained, from a bola device
C. Paralysed, from a ghoul claw	D. Frightened, from a fear effect

- 3 An enemy stands next to your Sorcerer. Which cast keeps a full hit chance?

A. Ray of Frost, an attack roll	B. Grease, a Dexterity saving throw spell
C. Fire Bolt, an attack roll cantrip	D. Chromatic Orb, an attack roll spell

- 4 A flat attack roll hits 65 percent of the time. The target is now Restrained. What is the hit chance?

A. About 42 percent to hit	B. About 72 percent to hit
C. About 88 percent to hit	D. About 95 percent to hit

PRIMARY SOURCE

Read the [bg3.wiki Prone](#) page and the [Paralysed](#) page. Each page is short. Each page lists the exact effect lines and the full list of sources that apply the condition. Ten minutes on those two pages cover the two most valuable conditions in the game.

ANSWERS

1. B. Attacks against a Prone creature have advantage only from within 3 m. The archer at 12 m rolls a flat die.
2. C. Paralysed makes any attack from within 3 m a critical hit. Blinded, Restrained, and Frightened do not.
3. B. Threatened gives disadvantage on ranged attack rolls only. A spell that uses a saving throw is not affected.
4. C. Restrained gives advantage on attack rolls against the target. Advantage turns a flat 65 percent into 88 percent.

PART II

The reference sheets



Five sheets give the numbers in compact tables.
Each sheet supports one lesson. Use a sheet during a
fight, and do not read it from the start.

REFERENCE SHEET 1

The d20 cheat sheet

BG3 MECHANICS · REFERENCE

This sheet gives the three rolls that the game makes, the parts of each roll, and the advantage table. Print this sheet.

THE THREE ROLLS

ROLL	FORMULA	BEATS
Attack	d20 + ability mod + proficiency	Target AC
Saving throw (the target rolls)	d20 + ability mod + proficiency if proficient	Your Spell Save DC
Concentration (you roll when hit)	d20 + Constitution mod + proficiency if proficient	10 or half the damage, whichever is higher

Spell Save DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + spellcasting ability modifier

The Sorcerer casts with Charisma. The Wizard casts with Intelligence. A natural 20 on an attack roll always hits and is a critical hit. A natural 1 always misses. A natural 1 on a concentration saving throw almost always ends the concentration.

PROFICIENCY BONUS BY LEVEL

LEVEL	1–4	5–8	9–12
Bonus	+2	+3	+4

FLAT ROLL: NEEDED FACE → HIT CHANCE

NEED	FLAT	ADVANTAGE	DISADVANTAGE
2	95%	99.8%	90%
5	80%	96%	64%
8	65%	88%	42%
10	55%	80%	30%
11	50%	75%	25%
13	40%	64%	16%
16	25%	44%	6%
20	5%	10%	0.25%

Need = AC – attack bonus. Advantage = 1 – miss². Disadvantage = hit².

ADVANTAGE RULES

- Advantage rolls two dice and keeps the higher die. Disadvantage rolls two dice and keeps the lower die.
- Multiple sources of the same kind do not stack. The game still rolls two dice.
- Any advantage plus any disadvantage cancels to one flat die.
- High ground gives +2 flat and low ground gives -2 flat. This bonus is not advantage, and it stacks with real advantage. [wiki](#)
- Common sources of advantage on attacks: the target is Prone, Restrained, Blinded, Paralysed or Sleeping; the attacker is Hidden or Invisible.
- Common sources of disadvantage: a ranged attack with an adjacent enemy; a ranged attack within 3 m; the attacker cannot see the target.

SAVING THROW PROFICIENCIES BY CLASS

CLASS	PROFICIENT SAVES	CLASS	PROFICIENT SAVES
Barbarian	Str, Con	Paladin	Wis, Cha
Bard	Dex, Cha	Ranger	Str, Dex
Cleric	Wis, Cha	Rogue	Dex, Int
Druid	Int, Wis	Sorcerer	Con, Cha
Fighter	Str, Con	Warlock	Wis, Cha
Monk	Str, Dex	Wizard	Int, Wis

Source: bg3.wiki, Saving throw. Use this table to predict the saving throws of enemy casters and to find your own weak saving throws.

KARMIC DICE

The game enables Karmic Dice by default. After failed rolls it increases the chance that your next roll succeeds. It also moves damage rolls toward the average value. It applies to enemies also, but it never forces an enemy saving throw to succeed. To make the table above correct, turn Karmic Dice off in the Gameplay options. [wiki](#)

REFERENCE SHEET 2

Saving throws

BG3 MECHANICS · REFERENCE

This sheet gives the Spell Save DC formula, the DC table by ability modifier and level, the chance that a spell lands, and the saves that each low-level spell targets. Print this sheet.

THE TWO FORMULAS

Spell Save DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + spellcasting ability modifier

target: d20 + ability modifier + proficiency bonus (if proficient) ≥ DC → the target saves

- The target succeeds when the result equals or exceeds the DC. [wiki](#)
- A saving throw has no automatic success on a natural 20 and no automatic failure on a natural 1. The only exceptions are concentration saves and dialogue saves. [wiki](#)
- A ray spell or a projectile spell rolls an attack against the Armour Class instead. An area spell or a point-target spell uses a saving throw. [wiki](#)
- The Sorcerer casts with Charisma. The Wizard casts with Intelligence. [wiki](#)

SPELL SAVE DC BY ABILITY MODIFIER AND CHARACTER LEVEL

ABILITY MODIFIER	LEVEL 1–4 (+2)	LEVEL 5–8 (+3)	LEVEL 9–12 (+4)
+2 (score 14–15)	12	13	14
+3 (score 16–17)	13	14	15
+4 (score 18–19)	14	15	16
+5 (score 20–21)	15	16	17

Proficiency bonus by level: [bg3.wiki](#), Sorcerer. The current Sorcerer run sits at Charisma 16 and level 2, so the DC is 13.

ABILITY SCORE TO MODIFIER

SCORE	1	4–5	6–7	8–9	10–11	12–13	14–15	16–17	18–19	20–21
Modifier	-5	-3	-2	-1	+0	+1	+2	+3	+4	+5

Subtract 10 from the score, divide by 2, and round down. Source: [bg3.wiki](#), Abilities.

NEEDED FACE → CHANCE THAT THE SPELL LANDS

Need = your Spell Save DC – the save bonus of the target. Land (flat) = $1 - (21 - \text{need}) \div 20$.

20. Land (target has disadvantage) = $1 - \text{save}^2$.

NEED	TARGET SAVES	SPELL LANDS	LANDS, TARGET HAS DISADVANTAGE
5	80%	20%	36%
8	65%	35%	57.8%
10	55%	45%	69.8%
11	50%	50%	75%
12	45%	55%	79.8%
13	40%	60%	84%
14	35%	65%	87.8%
15	30%	70%	91%
16	25%	75%	93.8%
18	15%	85%	97.8%
20	5%	95%	99.8%

There is no natural 20 floor on this table, because a saving throw has no automatic success. A need above 20 lands 100 percent of the time.

ADVANTAGE AND DISADVANTAGE ON SAVES

- Advantage and disadvantage apply to saving throws in the same way as to attack rolls. [wiki](#)
- Multiple sources of the same kind do not stack. The game still rolls two dice.
- Any advantage plus any disadvantage cancels to one flat die.
- Heightened Spell costs 3 sorcery points and gives the target disadvantage on its first saving throw. The Sorcerer gains this option at class level 3. [wiki](#)

SAVING THROW PROFICIENCIES BY CLASS

CLASS	PROFICIENT SAVES	CLASS	PROFICIENT SAVES
Barbarian	Str, Con	Paladin	Wis, Cha
Bard	Dex, Cha	Ranger	Str, Dex
Cleric	Wis, Cha	Rogue	Dex, Int
Druid	Int, Wis	Sorcerer	Con, Cha
Fighter	Str, Con	Warlock	Wis, Cha
Monk	Str, Dex	Wizard	Int, Wis

Source: bg3.wiki, Saving throw. Target the two abilities that the row does not list.

SAVE BY SPELL, LEVELS 1 AND 2

SPELL	LEVEL	SAVE	EFFECT OF A SUCCESSFUL SAVE
Grease	1	Dexterity	The creature does not fall Prone. Wizard list, or a Black or Acid Draconic Sorcerer.
Burning Hands	1	Dexterity	The target still takes half damage.
Thunderwave	1	Constitution	The target takes half damage and is not pushed.
Ray of Sickness	1	Constitution, after an attack roll	The target avoids Poisoned but still takes the damage.
Tasha's Hideous Laughter	1	Wisdom	The target avoids the condition. Wizard list only.
Hold Person	2	Wisdom	The target avoids the condition and repeats the save each turn. Humanoid targets only.
Sleep	1	None	No save. The spell affects creatures with cumulative HP below 24.

A damage spell still deals half damage on a save. A condition spell gives nothing on a save.

THE EXAMINE PANEL

1. Hover over the creature.
2. Press T.
3. Read the six saving throw numbers, the resistances, and the current conditions.
4. Choose the spell that targets the lowest number.

Sources: bg3.wiki, Abilities for the shortcut and the saving throws; Prima Games for the resistances and the conditions.

Warning: the save number can exceed the ability modifier, because a proficient creature adds its proficiency bonus. Read the save number itself, and use the ability modifier only as a fallback.

WEAK SAVE PATTERNS

Use these two patterns as a first guess. Confirm each guess in the Examine panel.

- Large brutes usually have low Dexterity and low Wisdom.
- Nimble enemies usually have low Strength and low Wisdom.

CREATURE	STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
Goblin Warrior	+1	+1	+0	+0	-1	-1
Ogre Brute	+4	+1	+3	-3	-2	-2
Ochre Jelly	+2	-2	+2	-4	-2	-5

Ability modifiers on Balanced difficulty. Other difficulties change some scores. These three stat blocks are verified. Do not apply them to other creatures.

REFERENCE SHEET 3

Damage types and resistances

BG3 MECHANICS · REFERENCE

This sheet gives the 13 damage types, the three modifiers, the icons of the Examine panel, the Wet combination, and the surface reactions. Print this sheet.

THE 13 DAMAGE TYPES

GROUP	TYPES	COUNT
Physical	Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing	3
Elemental	Acid, Cold, Fire, Lightning, Poison, Thunder	6
Other	Force, Necrotic, Psychic, Radiant	4

Source: bg3.wiki, Damage types.

THE THREE MODIFIERS

resistance → damage ÷ 2, rounded down
 vulnerability → damage × 2
 immunity → damage = 0

RULE	RESULT
Two resistances to the same type	Half damage. The modifiers do not stack.
Resistance plus vulnerability, same type	Normal damage. The modifiers cancel each other.
Immunity plus vulnerability, same type	0 damage. Immunity ignores the other modifiers.
Rounding	Halve the damage first, then round down.

Sources: bg3.wiki, Damage types and bg3.wiki, Resistances.

THE EXAMINE PANEL

Hover the cursor over a creature and press T.

Default keybinding "Examine / Pin Tooltip": bg3.wiki, Options.

MARK ON THE DAMAGE TYPE ICON	MEANING
Grey upward arrow	Resistance to non-magical sources. Damage from those sources is 50% lower.
Blue upward arrow	Resistance to magical sources. Damage from those sources is 50% lower.
Grey and blue upward arrow	Resistance to both magical and non-magical sources.
Red downward arrow	Vulnerability. Damage of that type is 100% higher.
Yellow outline on the shield	Immunity to magical and non-magical sources.
Grey outline on the shield	Immunity to non-magical sources only.

Spells are magical sources of damage. Weapons of uncommon rarity and above are also magical sources. A spellcaster therefore reads the blue arrows.

Source: bg3.wiki, Resistances.

WET

EFFECT OF WET	RESULT
Lightning damage	Vulnerable. The damage is doubled.
Cold damage	Vulnerable. The damage is doubled.
Fire damage	Resistant. The damage is halved.
Burning and Wild Magic: Burning	Immune.
Target already resists Lightning or Cold	The resistance is negated. The target does not become vulnerable.
Target is already Chilled	Both conditions are replaced with Frozen.
Target is invisible	Wet ends normal invisibility immediately.

Sources of Wet: deep water, steam clouds, and the spell Create Water.

Source: bg3.wiki, Wet.

Warning: Wet applies to your own party in the same way. Keep your melee characters out of the water.

CREATE OR DESTROY WATER

PROPERTY	VALUE
Level and school	Level 1, Transmutation. Costs an action and a level 1 spell slot.
Area	Radius of 4 m, at a range of 9 m.
Cleric and Druid	Learn the spell at level 1.
Conjuration School Wizard	Gets the Create Water variant at level 2, once per Short Rest, with no spell slot.
Storm Sorcery Sorcerer	Gets the spell at level 6.

Source: bg3.wiki, Create or Destroy Water. An Evocation Wizard and a level 2 Sorcerer do not have this spell.

SURFACE REACTIONS

SURFACE	DAMAGE APPLIED	RESULT
Water	Lightning	Electrified Water surface
Water	Cold	Ice surface
Water	Fire	Steam Cloud, which applies Wet
Ice	Fire	Water surface
Ice	—	Prone and Difficult Terrain on the creatures in it
Oil	Fire	An explosion, then a Fire surface
Alcohol	Fire	Fire surface
Alcohol	Cold	Ice surface

Source: bg3.wiki, Surfaces. The Steam Cloud applies Wet: bg3.wiki, Wet.

SPELL DAMAGE BY TYPE

SPELL	DAMAGE	TYPE	AVERAGE	NOTE
Chromatic Orb: Thunder	3d8	Thunder	13.5	Attack roll. No surface.
Chromatic Orb: Acid	2d8	Acid	9	Attack roll. Creates a surface.
Chromatic Orb: Cold	2d8	Cold	9	Attack roll. Creates an Ice surface.
Chromatic Orb: Fire	2d8	Fire	9	Attack roll. Creates a surface.
Chromatic Orb: Lightning	2d8	Lightning	9	Attack roll. Creates Electrified Water.
Chromatic Orb: Poison	2d8	Poison	9	Attack roll. Creates a surface.
Magic Missile	3 × (1d4 + 1)	Force	10.5	No attack roll. The darts always hit.
Ray of Frost	1d8	Cold	4.5	Cantrip. Attack roll. Reduces Movement Speed by 3 m.

Sources: Chromatic Orb, Chromatic Orb: Lightning, Chromatic Orb: Cold, Magic Missile, Ray of Frost. Upcasting adds 1d8 for each spell slot level above 1.

WORKED EXAMPLE: THE VALUE OF THE ELEMENT

CAST	TARGET STATE	AVERAGE BEFORE	AVERAGE AFTER
Chromatic Orb: Lightning, 2d8	Normal	9	9
Chromatic Orb: Lightning, 2d8	Wet, so vulnerable	9	18
Chromatic Orb: Fire, 2d8	Resistant to Fire	9	4.25
Chromatic Orb: Thunder, 3d8	Normal	13.5	13.5
Magic Missile, 3 × (1d4 + 1)	Normal	10.5	10.5

The resisted average is 4.25 and not 4.5. Resistance rounds down, and the rounding removes 0.25 damage on average over the 64 results of 2d8.

VERIFIED CREATURE MODIFIERS

CREATURE	MODIFIERS
Skeleton	Vulnerable to Bludgeoning. Immune to Poison.
Phase Spider	Resistant to Poison.
Wood Woad	Resistant to Piercing and Bludgeoning. Vulnerable to Fire.
Mud Mephit	Immune to Poison.

Goblins and gnolls are races, not single creatures. Their race pages list no resistance and no vulnerability. Examine each variant in the game.

Sources: bg3.wiki, Goblin and bg3.wiki, Gnoll.

REFERENCE SHEET 4

Turn resources and concentration

BG3 MECHANICS · REFERENCE

This sheet gives the four resources of a turn, the common action lists, the movement numbers, the reaction rules, and the concentration table. Print this sheet.

THE FOUR RESOURCES

RESOURCE	PER TURN	RECHARGE
Action	1	Start of the creature's turn
Bonus Action	1	Start of the creature's turn
Reaction	1	Start of the creature's turn
Movement Speed	7.5–10.5 m	Start of the creature's turn

Unspent resources do not carry over to the next turn. Items and features can grant extra charges.

COMMON ACTIONS AND COMMON BONUS ACTIONS

ACTION	BONUS ACTION
Dash	Jump
Disengage	Shove
Help	Dip
Main Hand Attack	Off-Hand Attack (Melee)
Ranged Attack	Off-Hand Attack (Ranged)
Throw	
Unarmed Strike	
Improvised Melee Weapon	
Perform	

Source: bg3.wiki, Actions. BG3 differs from tabletop 5e: Shove and Jump cost a bonus action here.

MOVEMENT NUMBERS

CASE	MOVEMENT SPEED
Dwarf, halfling, gnome	7.5 m (25 ft)
Most other races	9 m (30 ft)
Wood elf, wood half-elf	10.5 m (35 ft)
Dash action	Double for that turn
Difficult Terrain	Half: 2 m of movement per 1 m moved
Stand up from Prone	Half of the movement speed

REACTION RULES

- You hold 1 reaction per turn. It recharges at the start of your turn. [wiki](#)
- A reaction triggers on your own turn or on the turn of another creature. [wiki](#)
- Opportunity Attack triggers when an enemy moves out of your reach. The Disengage action prevents it. [wiki](#)
- Shield costs a reaction and a level 1 spell slot. It gives +5 Armour Class and immunity to Magic Missile until the start of your next turn. [wiki](#)
- Some class features use the reaction system without the Reaction resource. Examples: Divine Smite, Sneak Attack, Reckless Attack. [wiki](#)
- The Reactions tab sits on the spellbook page. The default hotkey is L. Each reaction has an enabled checkbox and an "Ask" setting for a prompt. [wiki](#)
- A creature with the Prone, Incapacitated or Sleeping condition cannot make an opportunity attack. [wiki](#)

CONCENTRATION

Concentration DC = half the damage taken, or 10, whichever is higher

Concentration save = d20 + Constitution modifier + proficiency bonus if proficient

You hold one concentration spell at a time. A second concentration spell ends the first one. A natural 1 almost always ends the concentration.

Source: bg3.wiki, Concentration.

Damage to DC to chance

The table gives the chance to hold the spell for a save bonus of +4. This bonus is a Sorcerer with Constitution 14 and a proficiency bonus of +2.

DAMAGE	DC	NEED	CHANCE AT +4	CHANCE AT +0
7	10	6	75%	55%
14	10	6	75%	55%
20	10	6	75%	55%
24	12	8	65%	45%
30	15	11	50%	30%
40	20	16	25%	5%

Damage up to 20 gives DC 10, because half of 20 is 10. A natural 1 always fails and a natural 20 always succeeds, so no chance is 100% or 0%.

Events that end concentration with no saving throw

- You cast a second concentration spell.
- You receive the Downed, Banished, Sleeping, Incapacitated, Prone or Rage condition.
- You dismiss the companion who holds the spell.
- You press the Flee Combat button.
- You cancel the spell with the x on the spell icon.

Source: bg3.wiki, Concentration. A move away from the enemies until combat ends does not break concentration.

Concentration status of common low-level spells

SPELL	LEVEL	COST	CONCENTRATION
Witch Bolt		1 Action	Yes
Hex		1 Bonus action	Yes
Bless		1 Action	Yes
Hold Person		2 Action	Yes
Web		2 Action	Yes
Cloud of Daggers		2 Action	Yes
Haste		3 Action	Yes
Grease		1 Action	No
Shield		1 Reaction	No
Ray of Frost	Cantrip	Action	No

SAVE PROFICIENCY AND CONCENTRATION

Each class gives proficiency in two saving throws. The Sorcerer is proficient in Constitution and Charisma, so the Sorcerer adds the proficiency bonus to every concentration saving throw. The Wizard is proficient in Intelligence and Wisdom, so Gale does not.

Source: bg3.wiki, Saving throw.

Give the concentration spell to the character with the higher concentration save bonus.

QUICKENED SPELL

Quickened Spell costs 3 sorcery points. The effect: "Spells that take an Action take a Bonus Action instead." The option becomes available at Sorcerer level 3. The wiki page states no limit on two levelled spells in one turn. Test this point in the game before you plan a turn around it.

Source: bg3.wiki, Metamagic.

REFERENCE SHEET 5

The conditions sheet

BG3 MECHANICS · REFERENCE

This sheet gives the control conditions, the effect of each condition on the target and on your attacks, and the level 1 to 3 spells that apply them. Print this sheet.

WHAT EACH CONDITION DOES

CONDITION	THE CREATURE CANNOT	ATTACKERS GET	SAVING THROWS
Prone	Move or take actions, bonus actions, or reactions. Standing up costs half the movement speed.	Advantage on attack rolls, from within 3 m only	Disadvantage on Strength and Dexterity
Paralysed	Move or take actions, bonus actions, or reactions	Advantage on attack rolls. An attack from within 3 m is always a critical hit.	Automatically fails all Strength and Dexterity
Hold Person	Move or take actions, bonus actions, or reactions	Attack rolls succeed automatically. An attack from within 3 m is always a critical hit.	Automatically fails Strength and Dexterity
Stunned	Move or take actions, bonus actions, or reactions. Concentration also breaks.	Advantage on attack rolls	Automatically fails Strength and Dexterity
Sleeping	Move or act	Advantage on attack rolls. Any hit from within 1.5 m is a critical hit.	Automatically fails Strength and Dexterity
Restrained	Move. Its own attack rolls have disadvantage.	Advantage on attack rolls	Disadvantage on Dexterity
Enwebbed	Move. Its own attack rolls have disadvantage.	Advantage on attack rolls	Disadvantage on Dexterity
Blinded	Make opportunity attacks. The range of its attacks and spells drops to 3 m. Its own attack rolls have disadvantage.	Advantage on attack rolls	No effect
Frightened	Move. Its ability checks and attack rolls have disadvantage.	Nothing. This condition gives no advantage.	No effect
Threatened	Make a ranged attack roll without disadvantage while a hostile creature is in melee range.	Nothing. This condition gives no advantage.	No effect. Melee attacks and saving throw spells are not affected.

HOW EACH CONDITION ENDS

- **Prone.** Usually after 2 turns. Grease, ice, and Throw give 1 turn. A creature that falls Prone on its own turn ends the turn at once and loses concentration. [wiki](#)
- **Paralysed.** When the duration of the source ends. Sources include Ghoulish Touch, ghoul and ghastr claws, and Paralysing Ray. [wiki](#)
- **Hold Person.** The target rolls a Wisdom saving throw at the end of each of its turns. The spell also needs your concentration. [wiki](#)
- **Stunned.** At the end of the turn of the affected creature. [wiki](#)
- **Sleeping.** On damage, on the Wet condition, on Help, or on a Shove. [wiki](#)
- **Enwebbed.** After 1 turn. The Web surface applies the condition again while the creature stays in the web. [wiki](#)
- **Blinded.** The duration falls at the start of each turn. Blindness lasts 10 turns, and the target rolls a Constitution saving throw at the end of each turn to remove it. [wiki](#)
- **Frightened.** At the end of the turn. Only one version of Frightened is active at a time. [wiki](#)
- **Threatened.** When no hostile creature stands in melee range. [wiki](#)

LEVEL 1 TO 3 CONTROL SPELLS

SPELL	LEVEL	SAVING THROW	CONDITION	CONCENTRATION
Sleep	1	None. Combined 24 hit points.	Sleeping	No
Grease	1	Dexterity	Prone, for 1 turn	No
Tasha's Hideous Laughter	1	Wisdom	Prone, plus Hideous Laughter for 10 turns	Yes
Hold Person	2	Wisdom	Hold Person, on a humanoid only	Yes
Web	2	Dexterity	Enwebbed	Yes
Blindness	2	Constitution	Blinded, for 10 turns	No

Sleep is the only spell in this list that uses no saving throw. Blindness is the only level 2 spell in this list that needs no concentration.

SHOVE

Shove is a bonus action. You roll an Athletics check against a DC from the passive Athletics or the passive Acrobatics of the target, whichever is higher. Shove pushes the target 1 m to 6 m. The distance depends on your Strength and on the weight of the target.

wiki

Warning: Shove does not knock a creature Prone by itself. A creature that falls at least 8 m is knocked Prone with no saving throw. A fall of 4 m or more also causes falling damage. wiki

THE COMBINATION RULES

- Apply the condition first, then attack. The attack of an ally later in the turn order gets the benefit.
- Prone and Paralysed reward melee range. Move the melee ally to within 3 m before the attack.
- Advantage never stacks. One condition that gives advantage is enough. Add high ground for a flat +2 on top. See the d20 cheat sheet.
- A flat 65 percent hit chance becomes 88 percent with advantage. See Lesson 1.
- Damage ends the Sleeping condition. Do not open with an area damage spell on a sleeping group.
- Choose the condition by the weakest saving throw of the target, not by the damage of the spell.

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This page lists every source that the book cites. The sources are grouped by lesson and by reference sheet. bg3.wiki is the primary source for the rules.

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